

THE EXTERIOR

With the exception of the engine cowling and “boot cowl” that wrapped around the forward part of the fuselage, the Cub’s airframe was covered in fabric. Like Henry Ford, William Piper made every effort to keep production costs to a minimum—so “Cub yellow” was the standard finish. “You can have any color, as long as it’s yellow!” Piper once quipped. With engine cooling “ears” and lift and undercarriage struts all sticking out in the breeze, the J3 Cub was never an aerodynamically fast airplane—but the fancy (and mud-trapping) wheel spats seen on this model might have been able to produce an extra mile an hour or so.

1. Piper’s famous bear cub logo 2. Rocker cover 3. Cylinders exposed for cooling
4. Exhaust pipe—the Cub was very well silenced 5. Fuel level indicated by cork float in tank 6. Wheel spats—an extra-cost option 7. Nonstandard extra wing tanks
8. Extended cabin glazing 9. Aileron control cable and pulley 10. Adjustable wing strut fork-ends 11. Fuel filler cap 12. Aileron cable turnbuckle 13. Trim mechanism connector

